

PRIORITIES

Monday

09.00 evidence that it is true? But this begs the question, says Hume! Grant that
10.00 nature has behaved largely uniformly up to now. We cannot appeal to this
11.00 fact to argue that nature will continue to be uniform, says Hume, because
12.00 this assumes what has happened in the past is a reliable guide to what will
happen in the future — which is the uniformity of nature assumption.
If we try to argue for the uniformity assumption on empirical grounds,
we end up reasoning in a circle.

• Science relies on induction, and Hume's argument seems to show that induction cannot be rationally justified.

Inference to the best explanation

16.00 • The inductive inferences we have examined so far have all had essentially
17.00 the same structure. In each case, the premise has had the form
"all examined Fs have been G", and the conclusion the form "other Fs are
also G". These inferences take us from examined to unexamined instances of
a given kind.

Example

- The cheese in the larder has disappeared, apart from a few crumbs.
- Scratching noises were heard coming from the larder last night.

Therefore, the cheese was eaten by a mouse.

• This inference is non-deductive.

wk	2024							wk	2024							
	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa	Su		Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa	Su	
09						1	2	3	14	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
10	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		15	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
11	11	12	13	14	15	16	17		16	15	16	17	18	19	20	21
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13	25	26	27	28	29	30	31		18	29	30					